

HC Services — People Code

Section 12: Education Allowance & Proof of Schooling Policy

Section 12.0: Document Control

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1.0	1 August 2026	—	First published edition, issued for the 2026–2027 academic year.

Section 12.1: Policy Scope

This policy covers the education allowance paid towards the schooling of an employee's dependent children, and the proof of schooling an employee must submit to claim it. It applies to every employee holding an education allowance entitlement under the Standard or Enhanced plan.

Claims are assessed against the plan and the academic cycle in force on the submission deadline, in line with the precedence rules at HC-PC-007 §7.1.

Section 12.2: Eligibility

12.2.1 Employment Status

An employee is eligible while their employment status is **Active** or **On Leave**. Approved leave does not interrupt entitlement.

12.2.2 Employment Dates

The employee must have joined on or before the submission deadline, and must not have left before the submission window opened. The dates decide eligibility, not the wording of the leaver record.

12.2.3 Eligible Dependants

The allowance is payable in respect of an employee's **children** only. The child must be recorded as an **Active** dependant and **Enrolled** at school in the employee's HR record. A dependant recorded as inactive, or not enrolled, is not eligible.

12.2.4 Employees Without an Entitlement

An employee whose benefits package carries no education plan has no entitlement under this policy. Where an employee believes their package is recorded incorrectly, they should contact People & Culture.

Section 12.3: The Annual Limit

12.3.1 Limit by Plan

The allowance is capped per eligible child, per academic year:

Plan	Annual limit per eligible child
Education Allowance – Standard	AED 25,000
Education Allowance – Enhanced	AED 45,000
No education plan	Not applicable

12.3.2 How the Limit Applies

The limit applies to each eligible child separately. It is a ceiling on what may be reimbursed, not an entitlement to that amount: only charges actually incurred and evidenced are reimbursed, and only those falling within §12.4.

12.3.3 Which Plan Applies

An employee's plan is recorded in their HR record. An employee may ask the HCS Concierge which plan applies to them.

Section 12.4: What May Be Claimed

12.4.1 Claimable Charges

The following charges are claimable under both plans:

Charge	Claimable
Tuition and academic instruction	Both plans
Registration and enrolment fees	Both plans
Examinations and assessments	Both plans
School activities and enrichment	Both plans
Books and learning materials	Enhanced plan only

12.4.2 Charges That Are Not Claimable

Any charge that does not fall within a category listed at §12.4.1 is not claimable. Uniform, transport, catering, private tuition outside the school, and voluntary contributions are common examples. Where an invoice mixes claimable and non-claimable charges, only the claimable lines count towards the limit.

12.4.3 One Claim per Child per Year

An academic year attracts one approved claim per eligible child. Where the same charge has already been claimed — by this employee or elsewhere — it is not payable again.

Section 12.5: Documents Required

12.5.1 The Four Documents

A complete claim consists of four documents:

Document	What it must state
Enrolment certificate	The child's name, date of birth, the school's name, the academic year, and the date of issue
Itemised school invoice	The child's name, the school's name, and the date of issue

Document	What it must state
Payment receipt	The date the payment was made
Employee declaration	That the employee has not claimed the same charges from another employer

12.5.2 Form and Legibility

Documents are submitted as PDF, PNG or JPEG, each no larger than 10 MB. A document that cannot be read — a poor scan, a photograph taken in low light, a page with a field obscured — will be returned for a clearer copy.

12.5.3 Authority

The enrolment certificate must carry either the school's stamp or the name and role of the person signing it.

12.5.4 Partial Submissions

A claim may be submitted in parts. It is not assessed until all four documents have arrived; until then the employee is told which are still needed.

12.5.5 Where to Send Them

Documents are submitted through the HCS Concierge, which opens the school verification window and shows what the claim still needs. An education allowance claim is **not** an expense claim, and the approval thresholds and submission deadlines at HC-PC-005 §5.7 do not apply to it.

Section 12.6: The Academic Cycle

12.6.1 The 2026–2027 Cycle

Claims for the 2026–2027 academic year are governed by the following dates:

Stage	Date
Submission window opens	1 August 2026
Submission deadline	15 October 2026
Review completed by	15 November 2026
Payroll cut-off	30 November 2026

12.6.2 Document Issue Dates

A document is accepted only if it was issued between **1 June 2026** and **31 May 2027**. A document from an earlier academic year is not accepted, even where the charges are otherwise claimable.

12.6.3 Late Submissions

A claim submitted after the deadline at §12.6.1 is not payable for that academic year.

12.6.4 Reminders

Employees with an open claim are reminded at 56, 28, 14 and 7 days before the submission deadline.

Section 12.7: How a Claim Is Assessed

12.7.1 What Is Checked

Every claim is checked for the following, and the employee is told which check a problem relates to:

Check	What it confirms
Completeness	All four documents at §12.5.1 have arrived
Required detail	Each document states what §12.5.1 requires of it
Identity	The names and date of birth on the documents match the HR record
Consistency	The documents agree with one another — same child, same school, same academic year, and the receipt settles the invoice it cites
Timing	The issue dates fall within §12.6.2 and the claim arrived by the deadline
Duplication	The same child has no approved claim for this year, and the invoice has not already been settled elsewhere

12.7.2 Outcomes

A claim where every check passes is approved without a human step. Any other claim is referred to People & Culture, who decide. A referral is not a refusal.

12.7.3 Correcting a Claim

Where a document is returned, the employee removes it and submits a corrected copy. The claim is reassessed in full. There is no limit on the number of corrections before the deadline at §12.6.1.

Section 12.8: Decisions and Appeals

12.8.1 Notification

An employee is told the outcome of their claim, and where it was not approved, which check it did not meet and what would resolve it.

12.8.2 Payment

An approved claim is paid through payroll, in the cycle following approval and no later than the payroll cut-off at §12.6.1.

12.8.3 Appeals

A decision under this policy may be appealed within **10 working days** of the written outcome, under HC-PC-009 §9.2.3. An appeal is heard by a manager who was not involved in the original decision.

For queries about this policy, contact People & Culture at people@hcservices.ae or raise a query via the HCS Concierge.